

North County Recycling and Transfer Station Siting Study

Clark County Council – Work Session

Solid Waste and Recycling Division

Joelle Loescher | August 26, 2026



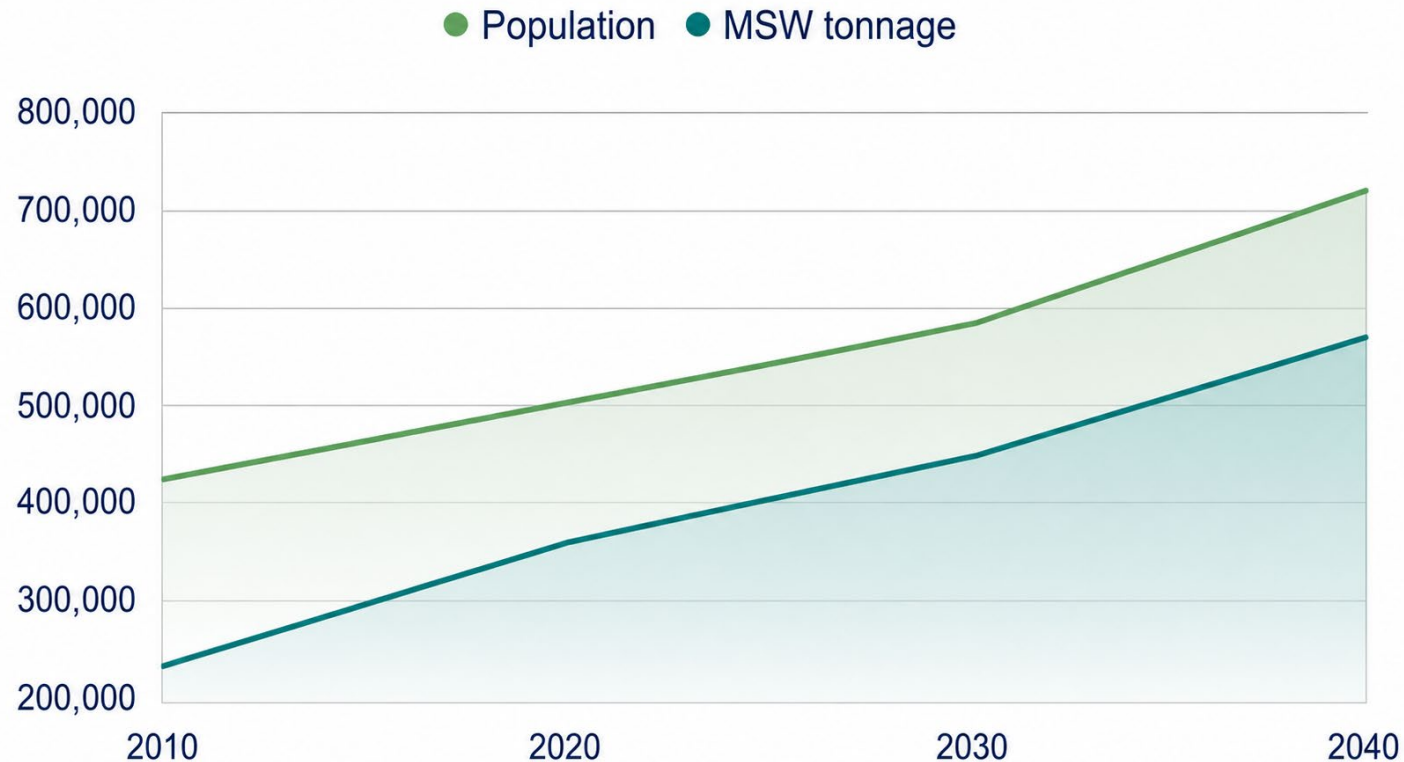
Why do we need a transfer station?

- Three existing transfer stations, located in the southern part of Clark County, currently operate at or near capacity.
- Adding a fourth transfer station in north county would help balance capacity by reducing strain on existing transfer stations and allowing for smoother, more accessible service.



Clark County population and MSW projections

- Clark County is projected to see a large population growth over the next several decades, significantly increasing municipal solid waste (MSW) generation in the region.



Our existing transfer system is aging

- West Van and Central transfer stations are more than 30 years old, and Washougal, the newest facility, is already 17 years old.
- Aging infrastructure requires ongoing maintenance, upgrades, and capital investment.
- Planning for a new North County facility **now** helps ensure capacity is available as the existing system ages and demand grows.

Transfer Station	Year Built	MSA End	Years in 2032
Central	1992	2032	40
West Van	1992	2032	40
Washougal	2009	2032	23
Estimated:	Year Built	30 Years	60 Years
North County	2032	2062	2092



Why do we need a transfer station?

- Residents and haulers in north county currently travel long distances to access southern stations. A new facility would cut travel time and provide better access for north county residents.

City/Town	Central TS	West Van TS	Washougal TS
La Center	25 Minutes	27 Minutes	41 Minutes
Ridgefield	19 Minutes	22 Minutes	33 Minutes
Yacolt	31 Minutes	51 Minutes	59 Minutes

*Does not include traffic or wait times

- The siting of a north county transfer station is part of a long-term, 60+ year strategic plan aligned with Clark County's Comprehensive Solid Waste Management Plan. It ensures solid waste infrastructure keeps pace with population and waste generation over decades.



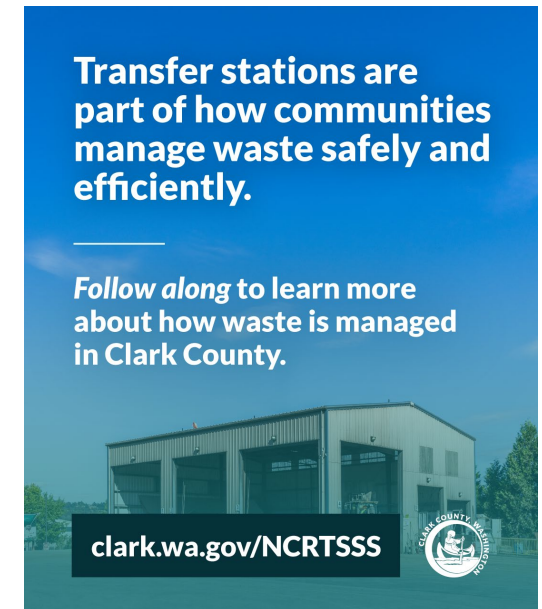
Council and Stakeholder Communication

Meeting Type	Forum	Topic	Year
Work session	- County Council - City Councils	Regional Solid Waste System Study	2023
RFP awarded - Staff Report – Council meeting	County Council	County Council voted to contract with Parametrix to search for a site to house a new Transfer Station in North County	2024
Work session – mention	- County Council - City Councils - SWAC - RSWSSC	NCRTS siting study	2025
Presentation – Quarterly meeting	SWAC	NCRTS siting study	2025
Presentation – Quarterly meeting	RSWSSC	NCRTS siting study	2025
Work session	County Council	Update on the siting study Phase 1	2026
Presentation – Quarterly meeting	RSWSSC	NCRTS siting study – Public Engagement Update	2026



Public outreach

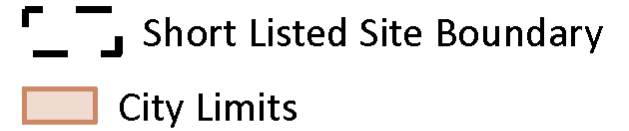
- Initial focus
 - Establish communications channels
 - General education
 - Build awareness
- Recent communications channels
 - Project webpage
 - Facebook
 - Instagram
 - Green Neighbors newsletter
 - Public comment form



Siting a transfer station

- **The siting process does not determine who will own or operate the facility.**
- Multiple ownership and operating models remain available, including:
 - Private ownership and operation (current model)
 - Public ownership with contracted operation
 - Public ownership with public operation
- Future ownership and operational structures would be evaluated separately from this siting study.





Recommendations

- Recommend the County Council approve an amendment authorizing staff to proceed with Phase 2 of the North County Recycling and Transfer Station siting process

What does Phase 2 involve?

- Reduce the four preferred sites to two and conduct a more detailed evaluation of the remaining sites
 - Conduct an Environmental Impact Statement (EIS) for the two remaining sites
 - Expand public outreach and engagement throughout the Phase 2 process
- Recommend the County Council conduct a public hearing on the siting of a North County Recycling and Transfer Station



Thank you!

Comments and questions

